

GateKeep

Stripe for the agent economy

The payment rail AI agents use to pay for APIs — automatically, per call, in stablecoins.

Investor Pitch · Built on Avalanche · Live on-chain demo · 2026

THE PROBLEM

Agents can’t pay the way humans do

Human rails break for agents

Credit cards need a cardholder. SaaS plans need a signup. API keys need a human to provision and rotate. None of it works for software making thousands of calls across services it discovered seconds ago.

Pricing is mismatched

Agent traffic is high-volume, low-value-per-call. Monthly subscriptions and $50 minimums don’t fit a workload that wants to spend a tenth of a cent per request.

No trust layer

When the buyer is a piece of software, “who is this agent, and can I trust it?” has no answer today. Sellers either block all bots — or get abused by them.

THE SHIFT

The internet was built to be paid for by humans.
The buyer just became a machine.

Autonomous agents now do real work — and real work means paying for things. But every payment rail on the internet assumes a human is holding the card.

WHY NOW

Three things just became true at once

01

x402 is real

The dormant HTTP 402 “Payment Required” status code is now an open protocol for machine-native payments. Payment becomes a property of the request itself — no checkout, no account.

02

Stablecoins + gasless transfers

Sub-cent, instant, global settlement is finally viable. With EIP-3009 the agent just signs — the transfer costs it zero gas. Micropayments actually work.

03

Agents became buyers

2025–26 is when agents went from demos to doing real work. The buyer on the other end of the API changed from a human to a machine — and the payment stack hasn’t caught up.

THE SOLUTION

Wrap any API behind a per-call paywall — in one click

For the API owner

Paste your API URL. Set a price — say $0.01 / call.

Get a gated URL back. Done.

Earnings settle on-chain; withdraw to your wallet anytime.

For the agent developer

Add one line: a payment-aware fetch wrapper.

The agent gets a 402, signs a USDC payment, retries, gets the data.

No accounts, no API keys, no invoices — ever.

We settle every call on-chain, take our cut, and pay the seller their share. **Like Stripe — for machine traffic.**

HOW IT WORKS

One request. One round trip. Fully automatic.

1

Call

Agent calls the gated URL with no payment.

2

402

GateKeep replies “Payment Required” with a price quote.

3

Sign

Agent signs a gasless USDC authorization and retries.

4

Settle

We verify, settle on-chain, take our cut.

5

Deliver

Upstream response streams back to the agent.

The agent developer writes none of this — the payment-aware client handles the whole handshake.

THE DIFFERENTIATOR

Payments that are identity- and reputation-aware

We don’t just move money — we’re the **trust layer for agent commerce.**

On-chain identity

Every agent has a verifiable on-chain identity (ERC-8004). Sellers can require it: “only known agents may call this endpoint.”

Reputation that compounds

Every successful payment builds the agent’s track record. Sellers can gate premium endpoints on it: “only agents that reliably pay.”

Proprietary, accretive data

We sit on the ledger of which agents actually pay. That dataset gets more valuable — and harder to copy — every single day.

BUSINESS MODEL

A take rate on every transaction

We skim a percentage of every call that flows through a gate.

No transaction, no fee. Every transaction, our fee.

Zero marginal cost per call. Revenue compounds directly with the growth of the agent economy.

Later: premium reputation & fraud-scoring data, enterprise SLAs, fiat on/off-ramps.

10%

platform take rate (tunable)

Agent pays	**$0.0100**
Seller gets	**$0.0090**
GateKeep	**$0.0010**

THE OPPORTUNITY

Every agent call is a transaction we can earn on

A new buyer class

Millions of agents are coming online, each making thousands of paid calls. That's a transaction volume that didn't exist two years ago — and it only points up.

Picks & shovels

We don't bet on any one agent or API winning. We monetize the traffic between all of them — the rail everyone has to cross.

Standards-native

Built on open protocols (x402, ERC-8004). We ride the ecosystem instead of fighting it — and we're the easiest on-ramp to it.

WHY WE WIN

The flywheel compounds



Two-sided network effects — each side pulls in the other. And the reputation ledger is **proprietary and accretive**: it's the thing sellers need to safely open up to bots, and it gets more valuable the longer we run.

STATUS

Working product — live on Avalanche

✓ Real on-chain settlement

USDC moves per call on Avalanche Fuji — every payment verifiable on Snowtrace.

✓ Gasless agent payments

Agents sign; they never hold gas. The full x402 handshake works end-to-end.

✓ One-click gates + dashboard

Create a paywall, watch the live call feed, withdraw earnings to your wallet.

✓ Identity + reputation live

ERC-8004 enforced: unregistered agents blocked, reputation accrues and unlocks gated endpoints — demonstrated live.

Built for the Avalanche "Agentic Payments" track — hitting the bonus: payments that are also identity- and reputation-aware.

THE ASK

Raising to take the rail to mainnet

Ship to mainnet

Production-grade settlement, security hardening, and reliability so real money flows safely.

Land the first 100 APIs

Integrate with the leading agent frameworks so GateKeep is the default payment line in every agent's toolkit.

Build the trust product

Turn the reputation ledger into the durable moat — scoring, fraud signals, the data sellers pay for.

The bet: when agents do most of the buying online, every paid call needs a rail that speaks their language. We're building it — and we earn a slice of each one.



GateKeep

When agents do the buying,
every call needs a rail that speaks their language.

Stripe for the agent economy.

Live demo + code: **github.com/anukulpandey/x402-payment-gate**